

Jeremiah: The Weeping Prophet

Faithful When It Costs Everything

Book 66 of 80

Little Believers Tigrinya Bible Stories

Ages 10-17

Written by Daniel Tesfamariam

*Key Verse: Jeremiah 1:5 — "Before I formed you in the womb I knew you,
before you were born I set you apart."*

SCENE 1

[PICTURE: A young boy, perhaps 15 years old, kneeling in a simple room as divine light streams down upon him. God's hand reaches from heaven toward the boy. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

In the small village of Anathoth, near Jerusalem, a young boy named Jeremiah knelt in prayer. He came from a family of priests and had grown up knowing God. But nothing could have prepared him for what happened next.

The voice of the Lord came to him: "Before I formed you in the womb I knew you, before you were born I set you apart; I appointed you as a prophet to the nations."

Jeremiah trembled. God had known him — truly known him — before he even existed. His life had purpose and meaning before his first breath. He was not an accident. He was chosen.

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(Ab na'ishto adi Anatot, ab tsiga Iyerusalem, hade ni'ishto qol'a simu Ermyas temberkikhu yitseli nebere.)

SCENE 2

[PICTURE: The young boy Jeremiah with hands raised defensively, looking overwhelmed and afraid, while a gentle divine glow surrounds him reassuringly. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

Jeremiah's first response was fear. "Alas, Sovereign LORD!" he cried. "I do not know how to speak; I am too young!"

He was perhaps only fifteen years old. How could he stand before kings and priests and deliver God's message? He was just a boy. The task seemed impossibly large for someone so small and inexperienced.

But God's answer was immediate and firm: "Do not say, 'I am too young.' You must go to everyone I send you to and say whatever I command you. Do not be afraid of them, for I am with you and will rescue you."

God did not dismiss Jeremiah's youth — He simply declared it irrelevant. When God calls, age is not a barrier.

“你這人怎麼這樣！”

[illegible]

*(Na'i Ermyas qedamay melsi firihi nebere. "Weyley li'ul Egzi'abher!" ilu tsew'e.
"Kizareb ayfeltin, ni'ishto iye!")*

SCENE 3

[PICTURE: A divine hand gently touching the lips of the young boy Jeremiah, with golden light flowing from the touch. The boy's eyes are wide with awe. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

Then the LORD reached out His hand and touched Jeremiah's mouth. The boy felt warmth spread through him like fire and honey combined — both burning and sweet.

"I have put my words in your mouth," God declared. "See, today I appoint you over nations and kingdoms to uproot and tear down, to destroy and overthrow, to build and to plant."

This was the moment everything changed. Jeremiah's words would no longer be merely his own. When he spoke, he would carry the very words of God. This was both the greatest honor and the heaviest burden a person could bear.

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(Shi'u Egzi'abher idu zergihu af Ermyas tenkefe. Iti qol'a kem hawin me'arin zitehawise miwqet tesema'o.)

SCENE 4

[PICTURE: Young Jeremiah seeing two visions side by side - an almond tree branch with white blossoms on one side, and a boiling pot tilting from the north on the other. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

God gave Jeremiah two visions to confirm his calling. First: "What do you see, Jeremiah?" The boy answered, "I see the branch of an almond tree." God replied, "You have seen correctly, for I am watching to see that my word is fulfilled."

The Hebrew word for almond sounds like "watching." God was telling Jeremiah: I am always awake, always watching, always keeping my promises — both for blessing and for judgment.

Then came the second vision: "What do you see?" Jeremiah said, "I see a boiling pot, tilting away from the north." God explained that disaster would come from the north upon all who lived in Judah because they had abandoned Him for false gods.

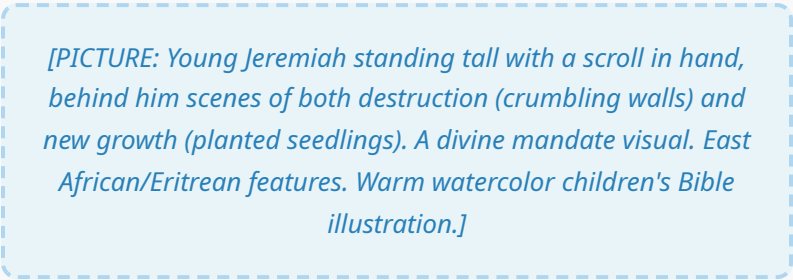
These two visions would define Jeremiah's entire ministry: God watches faithfully, and judgment is coming for the unfaithful.

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*(Amlak ni'Ermias kilte ra'iy habo tsaw'itu nimriggatsi. Qedamay: "Intay tri'i
Ermias?" Iti qol'a "Chenfer nay loz om yir'i aleku" ilu melese.)*

SCENE 5



God's commission to Jeremiah was unlike any other prophet's calling. He was appointed "over nations and kingdoms" — not to rule them with political power, but to speak God's word that would shape their destiny.

His mission had two sides: to uproot and tear down, to destroy and overthrow — but also to build and to plant. Before God could build something new, the old corruption had to be removed.

This is a difficult truth: sometimes God must tear down before He can build up. Sometimes the most loving thing is honest confrontation. Jeremiah would spend most of his life delivering the hard message of uprooting — but the promise of planting was always there, waiting beyond the judgment.

The young prophet took his first steps into a ministry that would last over forty years.

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(Nay Amlak tsaw'it ni'Ermyas kab kal'e nebiy zitefelye nebere. Ab li'li hizbitatn mengstitatn tesheyeme — bipolitikawy hayli kigez'om zeyikone gin qal Amlak kizareb.)

SCENE 6

[PICTURE: Young Jeremiah preaching passionately in a marketplace, gesturing toward idols on a hilltop while people go about their business, some glancing at him. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

Jeremiah began his prophetic ministry during the reign of good King Josiah. He preached in the streets of Jerusalem, calling the people of Judah to return to the living God.

"Your ancestors abandoned me," God spoke through Jeremiah. "They followed worthless idols and became worthless themselves. They exchanged their glorious God for gods that are not gods at all."

The people had placed idols on every high hill and under every spreading tree. They burned incense to Baal and poured out offerings to foreign gods. Yet they still came to the temple, thinking they could worship both God and idols.

Jeremiah pleaded: "Return, faithless people! I will cure you of your backsliding." But his words fell like seeds on hard ground.

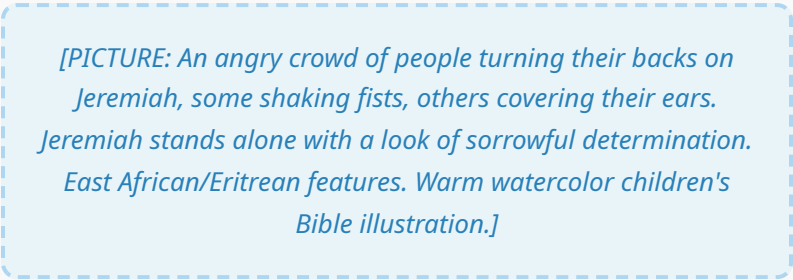
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*(Ermyas ab gize tsibuq nigus Yosyas nay nebiy agelgilotu jemere. Ab godenatat
Iyerusalem sebiku ni'hizbi Yihuda nab hiyal Amlak kimilesu tsew'e.)*

SCENE 7



The people's response was swift and brutal: "We will not listen!" They hardened their hearts against Jeremiah's message. The priests mocked him. The false prophets contradicted him. The people preferred comfortable lies to uncomfortable truth.

"Peace, peace," the false prophets proclaimed, "everything is fine!" But Jeremiah knew there was no peace — judgment was coming as surely as winter follows autumn.

Even his own family in Anathoth turned against him. "Do not prophesy in the name of the LORD," they threatened, "or you will die by our hands." His own brothers and relatives plotted against him.

This was only the beginning of rejection that would last his entire lifetime. Jeremiah learned early that faithfulness to God does not guarantee popularity with people.

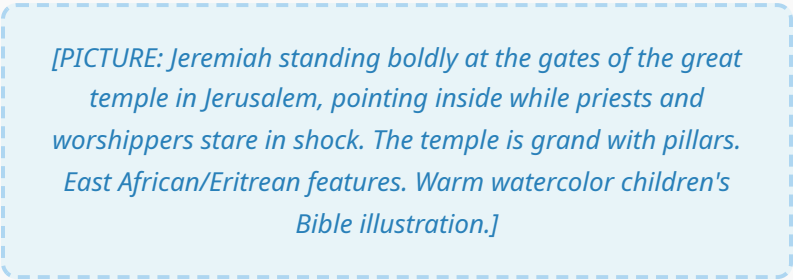
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*(Melsi hizbi qiltufin chekanin nebere: "Ayniism'in!" Libom ab li'li mel'ikhti Ermyas
atreru. Kahnat alagetsulu.)*

SCENE 8



God sent Jeremiah to stand at the gate of the temple itself — the holiest site in all of Judah. There, he delivered the most controversial sermon of his life.

"Do not trust in deceptive words and say, 'This is the temple of the LORD, the temple of the LORD, the temple of the LORD!'" Jeremiah thundered. The people believed that as long as the temple stood, God would never let Jerusalem fall. They used religion as a security blanket while living in sin.

"Will you steal and murder, commit adultery and perjury, burn incense to Baal — and then come and stand before me in this house and say, 'We are safe?'" God demanded through His prophet.

Jeremiah warned that God would destroy the temple just as He had destroyed Shiloh centuries before. The people were furious. They nearly killed him that day.

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(Amlak ni'Ermyas ab dege bete meqdes kiqewm le'akho — iti ziqedese bota ab kula Yihuda. Abu iti ziyada zikerakhere sibket aqrebe.)

SCENE 9

[PICTURE: Jeremiah walking alone through the streets of Jerusalem, watching families celebrate together while he remains solitary. His face shows acceptance mixed with loneliness. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

God gave Jeremiah an unusual command: "You must not marry and have sons or daughters in this place." This was extraordinary — in ancient Israel, marriage and children were considered the greatest blessings.

But Jeremiah's solitary life was itself a prophecy. God explained: "The sons and daughters born in this land will die of deadly diseases. They will not be mourned or buried." Jeremiah's loneliness was a living warning of the catastrophe to come.

God also told him not to enter houses of mourning or feasting. Jeremiah could not grieve with the grieving or celebrate with the celebrating. His entire existence became a message.

Imagine carrying this weight — watching others build families while you remain alone, knowing it is God's will for your life. Jeremiah obeyed, though it cost him deeply.

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*(Amlak ni'Ermyas zeyilmud ti'izaz habo: "Abzi bota ayitmer'a awedatn awaldn
aytitwled." Izi filuy nebere — ab tintawit Israel hadarn wiludn zi'abeye bereket
nebeye.)*

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*(Amlak ni'Ermyas "Nab bet serah sirah wured abu mel'ikhtey kihbeka iye" belo.
Ermyas keydu ni'serah sirah ab me'eweriu kisirih te'azebe.)*

SCENE 11

[PICTURE: Jeremiah alone in a dark room, on his knees with tears streaming down his face, hands clenched, pouring out raw emotion to God in anguished prayer. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

Throughout his ministry, Jeremiah did something remarkable — he recorded his private conversations with God. These "confessions" or laments reveal a man who was brutally honest with his Creator.

"Why does the way of the wicked prosper? Why do all the faithless live at ease?" he demanded. "You planted them, and they have taken root; they grow and bear fruit. You are always on their lips but far from their hearts."

"Cursed be the day I was born!" he cried in his darkest moments. "Why did I ever come out of the womb to see trouble and sorrow and to end my days in shame?"

These prayers teach us something vital: God can handle our honesty. He prefers raw, real prayer over polished, false praise. Jeremiah brought his anger, confusion, and despair directly to God — and God never condemned him for it.

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(Ab milu'e agelgilotu Ermyas zidenqi neger gebere — mis Amlak zigibero bihtawy zirirb tsehafe. Izen "nay nuzaze tselotot" mis fetariu bihaqqi qinu'u zinebere seb yer'iyana.)

SCENE 12

[PICTURE: Jeremiah standing in a field, looking up at the sky with arms outstretched in frustration and surrender, tears on his cheeks but determination in his posture. Storm clouds and sunlight mix above. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

"You deceived me, LORD, and I was deceived," Jeremiah cried out. "You overpowered me and prevailed. I am ridiculed all day long; everyone mocks me."

These shocking words reveal a prophet wrestling with God — not abandoning Him, but confronting Him. Jeremiah felt tricked. God had promised to be with him, yet the suffering never stopped. The rejection never ended. The loneliness only grew deeper.

Have you ever felt that way? That God led you somewhere difficult and then seemed to disappear? Jeremiah teaches us that this wrestling is part of faith, not the absence of it. He questioned God — but he never walked away.

Even in his accusation, Jeremiah could not deny what he knew: God was real, God had called him, and despite everything, God was still there.

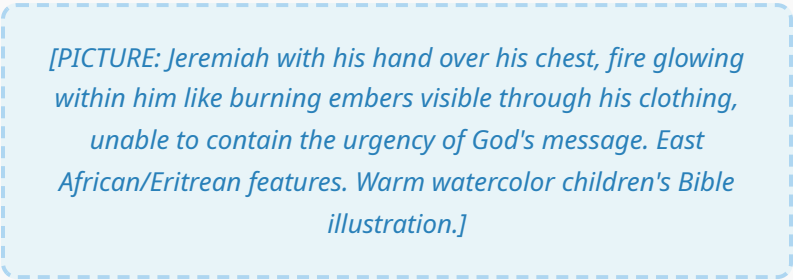
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*(Atalilkani Egzi'abher tetaliledima Ermyas tsew'e. "Haylka ar'ayekani te'awitka
dima. Milu'e me'alti yilagetsuley kulu yini'qeni.")*

SCENE 13



Despite all his suffering, Jeremiah discovered he could not stop speaking God's word. He tried. Oh, how he tried!

"But if I say, 'I will not mention His word or speak anymore in His name,' His word is in my heart like a fire, a fire shut up in my bones. I am weary of holding it in; indeed, I cannot."

This is one of the most powerful descriptions of prophetic calling in all of Scripture. Jeremiah wanted to quit — the pain was too great, the rejection too constant. But God's word burned inside him like a fire that could not be contained.

Sometimes obedience is not joyful enthusiasm. Sometimes it is simply being unable to do otherwise because God's truth has become part of who you are. Jeremiah could no more stop prophesying than he could stop breathing.

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фетину!

(Bizey kulu siqa'yu Ermyas qal Amlak kizareb kem zeyik'il derese. Fetinu. O kindey fetinu!)

SCENE 14

[PICTURE: King Jehoiakim sitting arrogantly by a fireplace, cutting pieces from a scroll with a knife and tossing them into the flames, while courtiers watch nervously. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

God told Jeremiah to write all His prophecies on a scroll. Jeremiah dictated every word to his faithful scribe, Baruch, who carefully recorded the messages on a long parchment.

The scroll was read publicly, and word reached King Jehoiakim. The king commanded that it be read to him. It was winter, and the king sat by a fire in his palace.

As each section was read, the king took a scribe's knife, cut off the portion that had been read, and threw it into the fire. Column by column, he burned God's word. No fear. No repentance. Just arrogant contempt.

The courtiers who watched did not tear their clothes in grief. They showed no fear. They had become so hardened that the word of God meant nothing to them. But truth cannot be destroyed by fire — as the king would soon discover.

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*(Amlak ni'Ermyas kulu tinbitattu ab tiqlelel kitsihif negero. Ermyas ni'amin
tsehafiyu Baruk qal biqal anbebo.)*

SCENE 15

[PICTURE: Jeremiah and Baruch working together by lamplight, Baruch writing intently on a new scroll while Jeremiah dictates with quiet determination. A burned scroll's ashes visible nearby. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

After the king burned the scroll, God spoke to Jeremiah: "Take another scroll and write on it all the words that were on the first scroll." So Jeremiah dictated again to Baruch — every prophecy, every warning, every word the king had tried to destroy.

But this time, God added even more words of judgment against the king who had dared to burn His message. Jehoiakim's contempt did not silence God — it only increased the judgment upon himself.

This is a powerful lesson: you cannot destroy truth by refusing to hear it. You cannot escape God's word by burning the page it's written on. Truth is not fragile. It survives every fire, every persecution, every attempt to silence it.

Jeremiah and Baruch simply wrote it all again — with additions. Persistence in the face of opposition is one of faith's greatest weapons.

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*(Nigus neti tiqlelel diHri miqtsalu Amlak ni'Ermyas tezarebo: "Kal'e tiqlelel wused
abti qedamay tiqlelel zinebere kulu qalat dima tsihafelu.")*

SCENE 16

[PICTURE: Jeremiah being lowered by ropes into a dark, muddy cistern by hostile officials. He sinks into the mud at the bottom, looking up at the small circle of light above. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

During the final siege of Jerusalem, Jeremiah continued to preach: "Surrender to Babylon and live. Stay and fight, and you will die." The officials were furious. "This man is weakening the soldiers!" they told King Zedekiah. "He must be put to death!"

The weak king gave in: "He is in your hands." So they took Jeremiah and lowered him by ropes into a cistern — a deep, underground water storage pit. There was no water in it, but there was thick mud at the bottom.

Jeremiah sank into the mud. Alone in the darkness. Left to die slowly of starvation and cold. This was the reward for forty years of faithful service — abandoned in a pit because he told the truth.

How many times had he warned them? How many tears had he shed? And this was their answer: silence him in the mud.

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*(Ab nay mewed'eta kibab Iyerusalem Ermyas kisibikh qetsele: "Ni'Babilon
tewefayu bihiyiwet tinebru. Tsenikhhum tewagi'u timotu." Haleqatat teqot'u.)*

SCENE 17

[PICTURE: An Ethiopian/Cushite court official named Ebed-Melech directing servants to lower old rags and ropes into the cistern to rescue Jeremiah. Jeremiah reaches up gratefully from the mud below. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

But God had not forgotten His prophet. In the royal court there was a man named Ebed-Melech, a Cushite — an African — who served as an official in the palace. When he heard what had been done to Jeremiah, he went directly to King Zedekiah.

"My lord the king, these men have acted wickedly. They have thrown Jeremiah into the cistern, where he will starve to death." The king authorized the rescue: "Take thirty men and lift Jeremiah out before he dies."

Ebed-Melech showed remarkable kindness. He gathered old rags and worn-out clothes, lowered them to Jeremiah, and said, "Put these under your arms to pad the ropes." He cared not just about saving Jeremiah's life, but about not hurting him further.

God always provides unexpected allies. Sometimes help comes from the person you least expect — a foreigner, an outsider, someone with nothing to gain but a clear conscience.

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*(Gin Amlak ni'nebiyu ayres'on. Ab bete mengisti Abed-Melek zisimu seb nebere,
Kushawi — Afriqawi. Ni'Ermyas zitegebre mis sem'e biqetita nab nigus Tsidiqiyas
kede.)*

SCENE 18

[PICTURE: Jerusalem burning, walls crumbling, Babylonian soldiers entering through breached walls. In the foreground, Jeremiah watches from a distance with tears streaming down his face. Smoke fills the sky. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

In 586 BC, after years of warnings that went unheeded, everything Jeremiah had prophesied came true. Nebuchadnezzar's army breached the walls of Jerusalem. The city that had seemed invincible fell.

The temple — the one they believed God would never allow to be destroyed — was burned to the ground. The palace was destroyed. The walls were torn down. The people were killed or carried away to Babylon in chains.

King Zedekiah tried to flee but was captured. His sons were killed before his eyes, and then his eyes were put out — the last thing he ever saw was his children's death. He was led to Babylon in chains.

Jeremiah had been right all along. For over forty years he had warned them. But being right brought him no joy — only the deepest sorrow imaginable.

586 B.C. The Babylonians destroyed Jerusalem. The temple was burned down, and the walls were broken down. The king and his sons were killed, and the people were taken into captivity. Jeremiah was left alone in the ruins of the city.

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*(Ab 586 q.l.k diHri ametati zeyitesmi'e mitinqaqi kulu Ermyas zitenebeyo haqi
 kone. Serawit Nabukedenester ni'mendeq Iyerusalem sebero.)*

SCENE 19

[PICTURE: Jeremiah sitting among the ruins of Jerusalem, rubble and burned buildings around him, weeping bitterly with his head in his hands. Other survivors wander aimlessly in the background. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

Jeremiah did not celebrate being proven right. He wept. He is called "the weeping prophet" because his response to judgment was not "I told you so" but overwhelming grief.

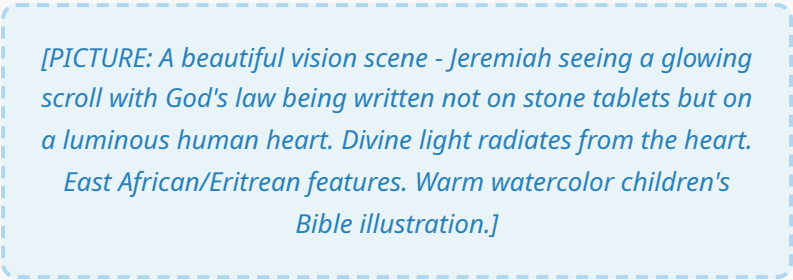
"Oh, that my head were a spring of water and my eyes a fountain of tears! I would weep day and night for the slain of my people," he had written earlier. Now that grief became reality.

The book of Lamentations, traditionally attributed to Jeremiah, captures his agony: "How deserted lies the city, once so full of people! How like a widow is she, who once was great among the nations!"

This teaches us something profound about prophetic love: Jeremiah did not warn them because he wanted to be right. He warned them because he loved them. And when they suffered the consequences of their rebellion, he suffered with them. True love grieves even when it has been rejected.

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SCENE 20



But in the midst of all this darkness, Jeremiah delivered one of the most hopeful prophecies in all of Scripture — the promise of a New Covenant:

"The days are coming," declares the LORD, "when I will make a new covenant with the people of Israel. It will not be like the covenant I made with their ancestors... I will put my law in their minds and write it on their hearts. I will be their God, and they will be my people."

"No longer will they teach their neighbor, saying, 'Know the LORD,' because they will all know me, from the least of them to the greatest. For I will forgive their wickedness and will remember their sins no more." (Jeremiah 31:31-34)

This prophecy points directly to Jesus and the gift of the Holy Spirit. God's law would no longer be external rules on stone — it would become an internal reality written on the heart. This is the covenant we live under today.

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*(Ab ma'ikel izi kulu tselmat Ermyas ab kulu qidus tsihuf kab ziyada zitesfa zihibi
tinbit aqrebe — nay hadish kidan tesfa.)*

SCENE 21

[PICTURE: A letter being read by Jewish exiles in Babylon beside a river, their faces showing surprise and hope. In the background, small houses they've built in exile. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

Even after Jerusalem fell, Jeremiah continued his ministry. He sent a letter to those already in exile in Babylon with one of the most beloved verses in Scripture:

"For I know the plans I have for you," declares the LORD, "plans to prosper you and not to harm you, plans to give you hope and a future. Then you will call on me and come and pray to me, and I will listen to you. You will seek me and find me when you seek me with all your heart." (Jeremiah 29:11-13)

But this promise came with a surprising instruction: "Build houses and settle down; plant gardens and eat what they produce. Marry and have sons and daughters... Seek the peace and prosperity of the city where I have carried you into exile."

God was saying: this exile is not the end. I have a future for you. But right now, bloom where you are planted. Trust my timing, not your own.

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*(Iyerusalem diHri miwdaqa'win Ermyas agelgilotu qetsele. Dro ab Babilon nab
zineberu sideteñatat debdabe le'akhe ab qidus tsihuf kab zifiqeru tiqistat hade
zihaze.)*

SCENE 22

[PICTURE: An older Jeremiah, weathered but dignified, standing against a timeline showing decades of his ministry - from youth to old age. Seasons change behind him but his posture of faithfulness remains constant. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

For over forty years, Jeremiah faithfully delivered God's message. Think about that: more than four decades of constant rejection. He served under five different kings, and not one of them truly listened.

He never saw revival in his lifetime. He never experienced the joy of a nation turning back to God. He never received honor or recognition from his people. He died in obscurity, likely in Egypt, taken there against his will by fleeing refugees.

By every worldly measure, Jeremiah's ministry was a failure. No converts. No followers. No victory parade. Just faithfulness — day after day, year after year, decade after decade.

But by God's measure, Jeremiah was one of the greatest prophets who ever lived. His words are still read today, three thousand years later. His prophecy of the New Covenant became the foundation of Christian faith. Faithfulness is never wasted, even when we cannot see the results.

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*(Nili'li arb'a amet Ermyas bi'aminnet mel'ikhti Amlak amehalilefe. Hisebwo: li'li
arba'te aserite amet nay qetsali minitsag.)*

SCENE 23

[PICTURE: A split image - one side showing Jeremiah enduring hardship (chains, mockery, loneliness) and the other side showing a crown of light and eternal reward above him. The contrast between earthly cost and heavenly value. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

What did faithfulness cost Jeremiah? Everything. He never married or had children. He was rejected by his family, his community, his nation. He was beaten, imprisoned, thrown into a pit, and threatened with death countless times.

He lived in poverty while false prophets lived in luxury. He preached doom while they promised peace. The people loved them and hated him.

But what did faithfulness gain him? The privilege of carrying God's word. The honor of speaking truth when lies dominated. The eternal legacy of the New Covenant prophecy. And most importantly — the approval of God Himself.

Jesus later said, "Well done, good and faithful servant." Jeremiah may never have heard those words in this life. But he lived for an audience of One. And that One never forgot his faithfulness.

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*(Aminnet ni'Ermayas intay wetsa'o? Kulu neger. Ayitemer'an qol'u ayneberwon.
Bisidra betu bimahibere sebu bihageru tenetsege.)*

SCENE 24

[PICTURE: A visual parallel showing Jeremiah on one side weeping over Jerusalem and Jesus on the other side weeping over Jerusalem from the Mount of Olives. Both figures share the same posture of sorrowful love. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

Jeremiah foreshadowed Jesus in remarkable ways. Both were rejected prophets who loved their people despite being hated. Both wept over Jerusalem. Both were persecuted by religious leaders. Both spoke truth that people refused to hear.

Jesus Himself was sometimes mistaken for Jeremiah (Matthew 16:14). The people saw the same spirit in Jesus — the weeping prophet who loved fiercely and spoke truth fearlessly.

But where Jeremiah could only prophesy the New Covenant, Jesus established it. Where Jeremiah's tears could not save, Jesus' blood could. Where Jeremiah's words pointed to hope, Jesus became the hope.

Jeremiah's life was a shadow pointing toward a greater Prophet who would come — one who would not just announce God's forgiveness but accomplish it through His own sacrifice on the cross.

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SCENE 25

[PICTURE: A modern young person standing confidently, holding a Bible, with a faint image of young Jeremiah beside them like a spiritual companion. Light shines on both of them from above. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

What does Jeremiah's story mean for you today? Perhaps you feel too young to make a difference. Perhaps you've spoken truth and been rejected. Perhaps you wonder if faithfulness matters when no one seems to notice.

Jeremiah's life answers: God knew you before you were born. Your age does not limit your calling. Faithfulness is measured by obedience, not by results. And God's plans for you are good — even when the path is painful.

You may never see the full fruit of your faithfulness in this life. Jeremiah didn't. But every act of obedience matters eternally. Every truth spoken in love echoes through generations. Every prayer of honest struggle reaches God's heart.

Like Jeremiah, you are called to be faithful — not successful by the world's standards, but faithful by God's. Trust that the One who formed you in the womb has purposes for you that extend far beyond what you can see today.

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The Moral of the Story

Faithfulness is not measured by results — it is measured by obedience.

Jeremiah's life teaches us that God calls us before we are born and equips us for purposes we may never fully understand. Being young is no barrier to God's calling. Being rejected is not a sign of failure. Speaking truth when it is unpopular is one of the bravest things a person can do.

Like fire shut up in our bones, God's truth demands to be spoken. We may not see the harvest from our faithfulness, but God sees every seed planted, every tear shed, and every prayer offered. His plans for us are good — plans for hope and a future — even when the present is painful.

The question is not "Will people listen?" but "Will I be faithful?" Jeremiah answered that question with his entire life: Yes, Lord. No matter the cost.

Jeremiah was a young man when he was called by God to be a prophet.

He was called to speak the truth to the king and the people, even when it was unpopular. He was called to stand for God's law, even when it cost him his life.

Jeremiah's life teaches us that God calls us before we are born and equips us for purposes we may never fully understand. Being young is no barrier to God's calling. Being rejected is not a sign of failure. Speaking truth when it is unpopular is one of the bravest things a person can do.

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*(Aminnet bi'wits'it zeyikone bi'izuznet yi'qen. Hiyiwet Ermyas Amlak qidmi
miwladna kem zitsuw'anan nizeyinird'o ilama kem zidalwena yimhirena.)*

Discussion Questions

1. **Jeremiah said "I am too young" when God called him. Have you ever felt too young or unqualified for something God was asking you to do? How does God's response to Jeremiah encourage you?**

Jeremiah said "I am too young" when God called him. Have you ever felt too young or unqualified for something God was asking you to do? How does God's response to Jeremiah encourage you?

2. **Jeremiah was faithful for over 40 years without seeing positive results. How do you stay faithful to God when you don't see immediate results from your obedience? What motivates you when no one seems to notice?**

Jeremiah was faithful for over 40 years without seeing positive results. How do you stay faithful to God when you don't see immediate results from your obedience? What motivates you when no one seems to notice?

3. **Jeremiah prayed very honest, raw prayers — even accusing God of deceiving him. Do you think it's okay to be completely honest with God about your frustrations and doubts? Why or why not?**

Jeremiah prayed very honest, raw prayers — even accusing God of deceiving him. Do you think it's okay to be completely honest with God about your frustrations and doubts? Why or why not?

4. Speaking truth when it's unpopular is very difficult. Can you think of a time when you had to say something true even though others didn't want to hear it? What happened? How can we speak truth with both courage and love?

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5. Jeremiah 29:11 says God has plans to give us "hope and a future." How do you hold onto this promise during times of suffering or confusion? How does Jeremiah's story help you trust God's long-term plan even when things seem to be falling apart?

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Let Us Pray

Dear Heavenly Father,

Thank You for knowing us before we were born and setting us apart for Your purposes. Thank You for the example of Jeremiah — a man who was faithful when it cost him everything.

Give us courage like Jeremiah to speak Your truth even when it is unpopular. Give us faithfulness regardless of results — help us to obey You whether people listen or not. Give us honest hearts that bring our real feelings to You in prayer, knowing You can handle our doubts and frustrations.

Lord, when we feel too young or too small for what You're calling us to do, remind us that You do not measure by age or ability but by willingness. When we face rejection for doing right, help us remember that Your approval matters more than human applause.

Write Your law on our hearts as You promised through Jeremiah. Make Your word like fire in our bones that we cannot contain. And help us trust Your plans for hope and a future, even when the present is painful and the path is unclear.

In Jesus' name we pray, Amen.

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*(Zikeberka semayawi Abo, Qidmi miwladna felitikana ni'ilamaka felyukana sle
zeleka nemesGINEKA. Ni'abnet Ermyas nemesgin — kulu neger wets'ao kelo
amin zinebere seb.)*

Little Believers Tigrinya Bible Stories

Written by Daniel Tesfamariam

Book 66 of 80

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"Before I formed you in the womb I knew you, before you were born I set you apart."

— *Jeremiah 1:5*

Thank you for reading! May this story inspire faithfulness and courage in your life, knowing that the God who called Jeremiah has a purpose for you too.

